Claude Overload



or: How I Learned to Stop Worrying and Love the Code Agent

Part I

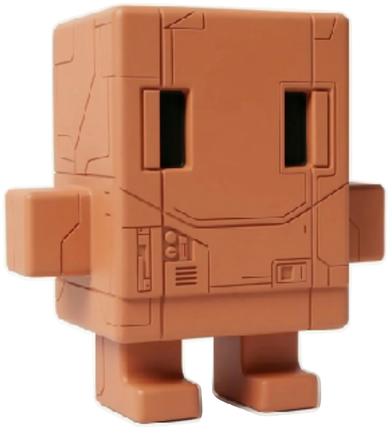
Colin Swaney, October 2, 2026

What *is* Claude Code?



You

User-Agent



Agent-Model

Fable
Opus
Sonnet
Haiku

Context
Files
Skills
Instructions

Tools
Bash
Filesystem
Web

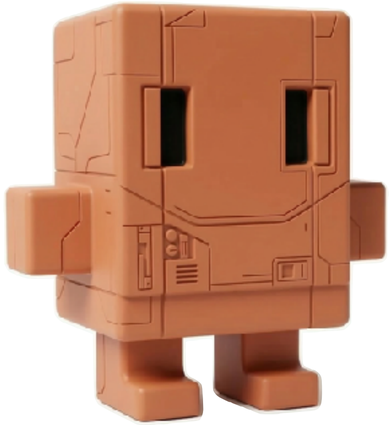
How does this work?



You

"What's the latest version of React?"

"React 19.2"



Agentic loop

1 Forward message - tool use response

"What's the latest version of React?" + tools

"tool_use: WebSearch(query)"

2 Tool use result - final response

"[{'title': ...}]"

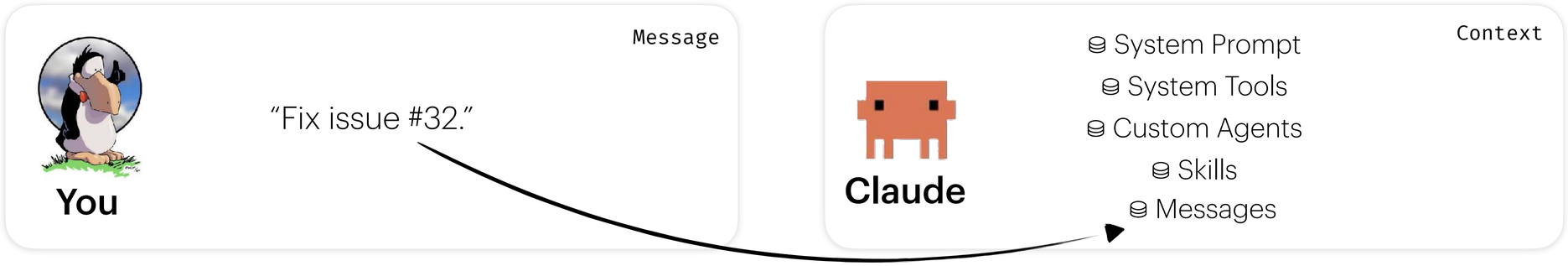
"React 19.2"

Opus

Context & Tokens

Markdown All the Way Down

- **Context** is *everything* passed to the LLM
- Context accumulates throughout the conversation
- Many actions—Read, Bash,WebSearch—insert “hidden” context
- Limited to 200k or 1M tokens per session



Use `/context` to view your current context usage.



Use `/clear` and `/compact` clean up session context.



What can Claude Code do?

Use your imagination

Research

Literature Review
Custom Article Feed
Peer Review

Code

Prototype
Explain
Document
Translate



Data

Wrangling
Analysis
Plotting

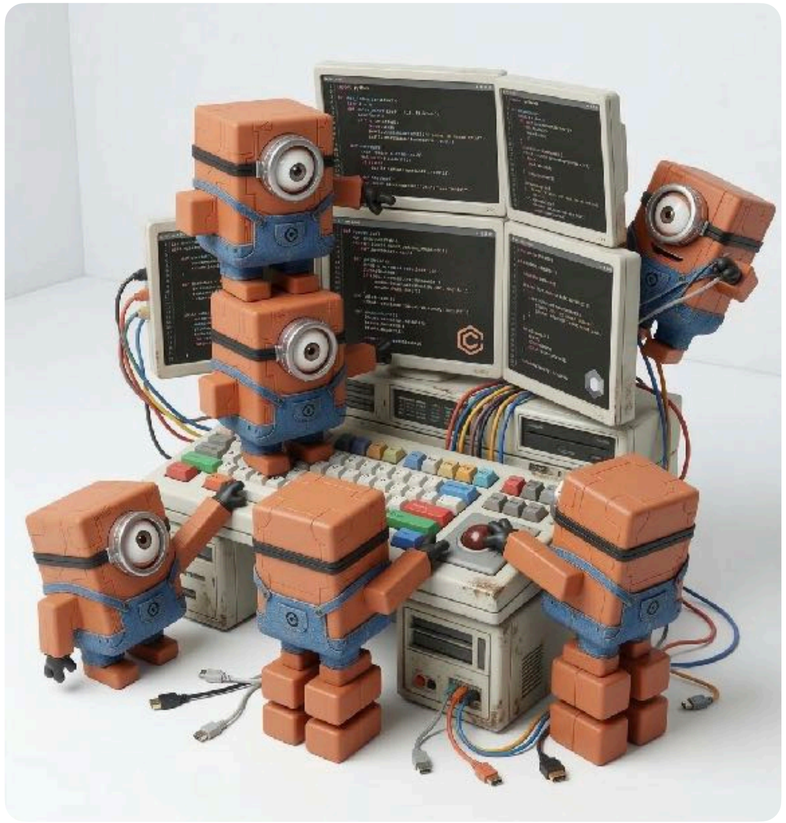
Text

Copy Editing
Methods Documentation
Summarization

What do I use Claude for?

SWE Minion

- ✏️ Feature planning
- 🐞 Bug fixes
- 🔍 Code reviews
- 🦺 Quick(er) prototypes
- 📚 Study partner
- 🛜 Web search
- 🧪 Test writer





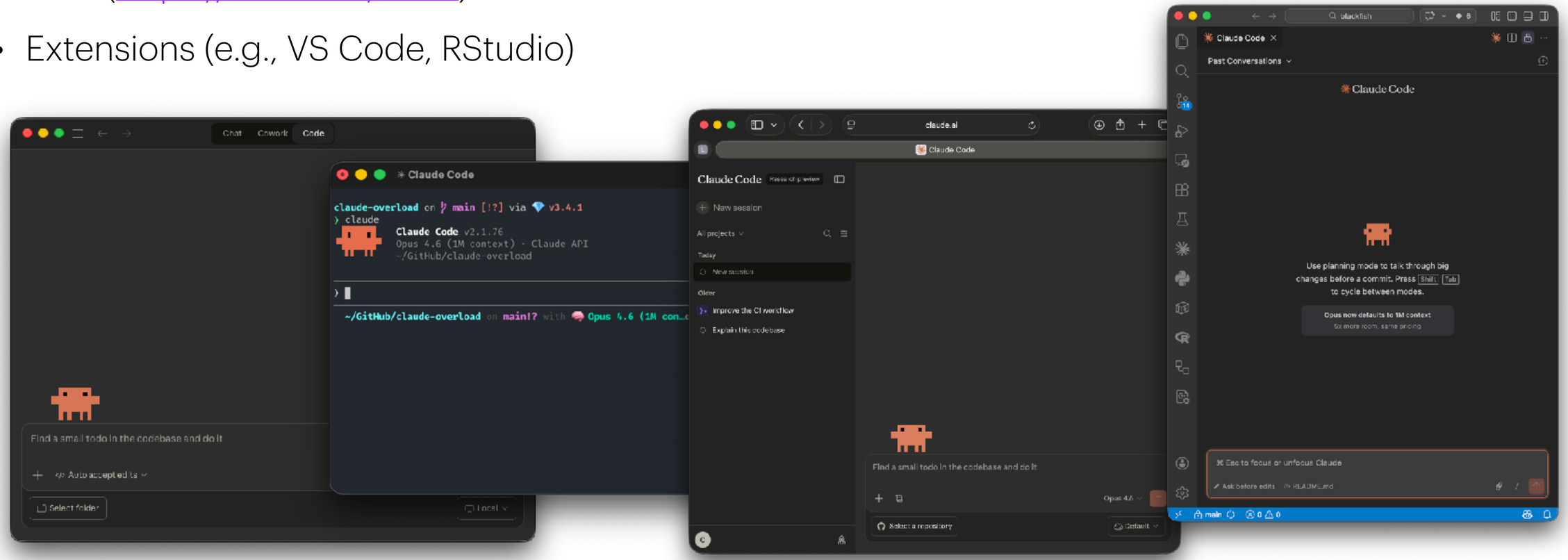
Warning

Claude is not magic. Claude makes mistakes. You should not blindly believe everything Claude says. Just because you **`can`** do something doesn't mean you **`should`** do it. Please read tool permission requests before approving. Using random plugins not advised.

How to get started?

Take your pick

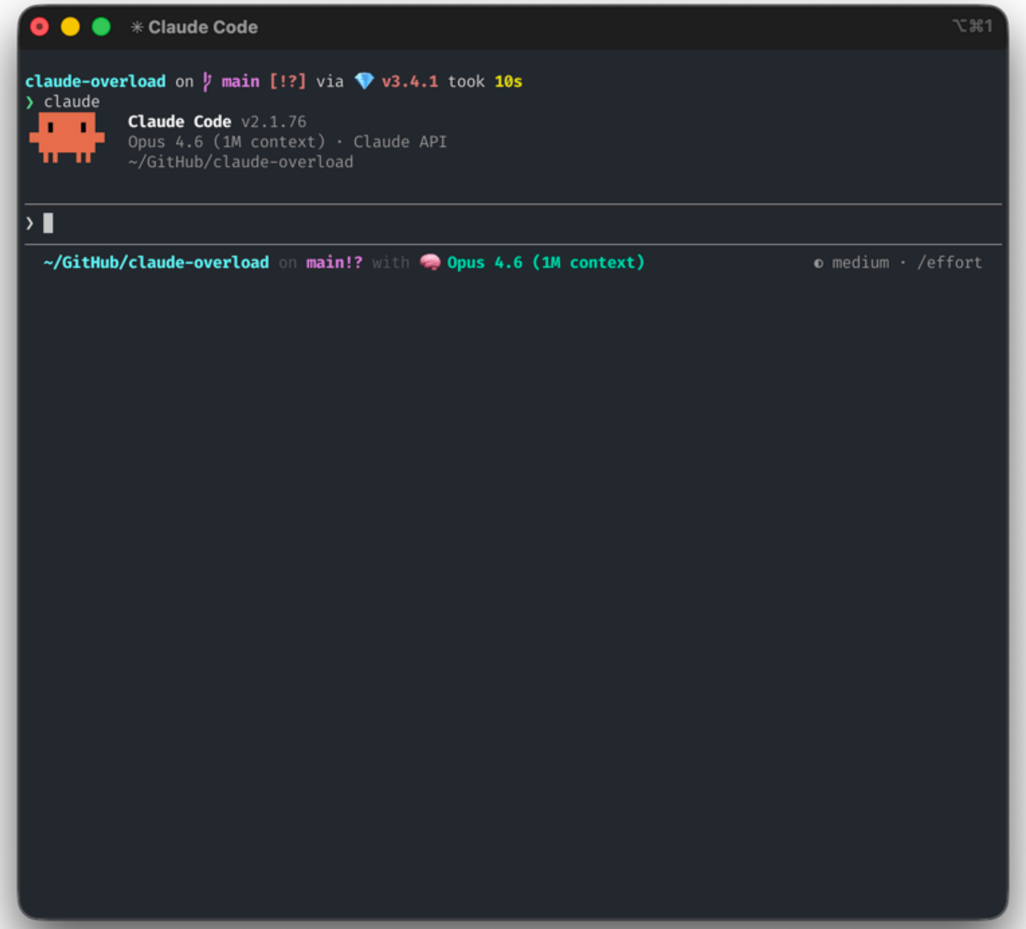
- Command Line Interface (CLI)
- Desktop & Mobile
- Web (https://claude.ai/code)
- Extensions (e.g., VS Code, RStudio)



Claude Code CLI

One Interface to Rule Them All?

- You’re going to be typing a lot anyway—and it’s really fast 💨
- Claude uses the command line
  - Bash
  - Git
- Easy to examine internals
- Customize your look and feel
- (But extensions also nice—integration might be non-negotiable for you)



Demo

End

Changelog

Summary

- Model updates: Opus 5.5 and Fable 5.1 (9/26)
- 1M-token context
- Auto mode (3/26-8/26)
- Subagents background by default
- Agents teams (research preview)
- Workflows and “Ultracode”
- Agent view
- Cross-session messaging (8/26)
- Remote control (2/26)
- Artifacts
- Auto-memory (2/26)
- AGENTS.md support (9/26)
- HTTP hooks
- /powerup